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LETTERS TO MY SON

On Brotherhood

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

You become the average of the men you keep close. These letters are on choosing your company, and loving those who matter while they can hear it.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Spend your evenings among men worth becoming.

The company you keep tonight is the man you become next year.

Choose the room before you choose the words.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

People judge you in the first minute and rarely revise it.

Your manner speaks before your mouth does. Make the first silence say something good.

Walk in as the man you wish to be seen as.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Decide whom to trust before you trust, not after.

Ponder long whether a man belongs in your life — but
once he does, let him all the way in.

Choose slowly, then commit fully.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Good company is the finest school there is.

You learn more judgement and ease in the right room than
in any book.

Sit where the men you admire sit.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

First decide, then trust, not the other way round.

Weigh a man slowly. But once you have chosen him, give him your whole confidence.

Judge before the gate; trust beyond it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Good company is the finest school a young man can attend.

You learn more judgement in the right room than in any book.

Sit where the men you admire sit.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

You can read a man by how he treats those who can do nothing for him.

Power reveals; watch how he uses the small kind he holds.

Judge by the unguarded moments.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Say to those you love that you love them, plainly, while
they can hear it.

A eulogy is love that arrived too late to be of use.

Say it now, in your own clumsy words.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Envy is admiration that lost its nerve.

Let another man's success be a map, not a wound.

Study what you envy, then go earn it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Spend your hours with those who make you better, not merely comfortable.

Easy company keeps you where you are; demanding company moves you up.

Choose the friends who raise your floor.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A real friend tells you the thing the flatterer hides.

Praise feels good and teaches nothing; honest friction shapes you.

Keep the friend brave enough to correct you.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Treat each man you meet as though he carries a hidden burden.

Most rudeness is pain in disguise; most coldness, fear.

Leave people lighter than you found them.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A friend chosen in haste is a regret chosen in advance.

Test a man in small things before you trust him with large ones.

Prove the bond before you lean on it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Listen as though the other man knows something you do not.

He usually does, and the humble ear gathers what the proud tongue never will.

Hear first; speak last.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Isolation is a slow death dressed as independence.

Your friends are the library of all you will become.

Choose wisely.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The lone wolf is admired in stories and starves in life.

Your friends are the library of all you will become.

Your brothers matter.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father